

Chapter 3: Stacks



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Today's Outline



1. What is a Stack?
2. Stack Abstract Data Type
3. Simple Array-Based Stack Implementation
4. Stack Applications

Linear Data Structures



- Items are ordered depending on how they are added or removed.
 - Arrays
 - Stacks
 - Queues

What is a Stack?

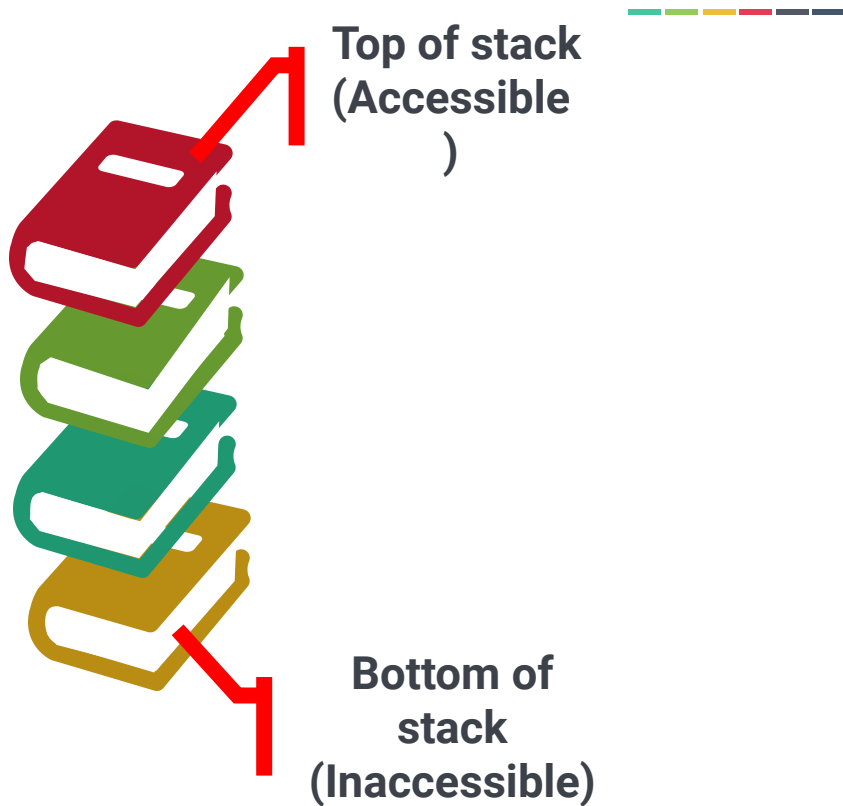


A stack is a collection of objects that are inserted and removed according to the ***last-in first-out (LIFO)*** principle [1].

The name “stack” is derived from the metaphor of a stack of plates in a plate dispenser.



Stack of Books



Stack Abstract Data Type



To create an instance of a stack, use `Stack()`.

Formally, there are 2 main operations of stacks:

- 1) `push(item)`
- 2) `pop()`

Stack of Books



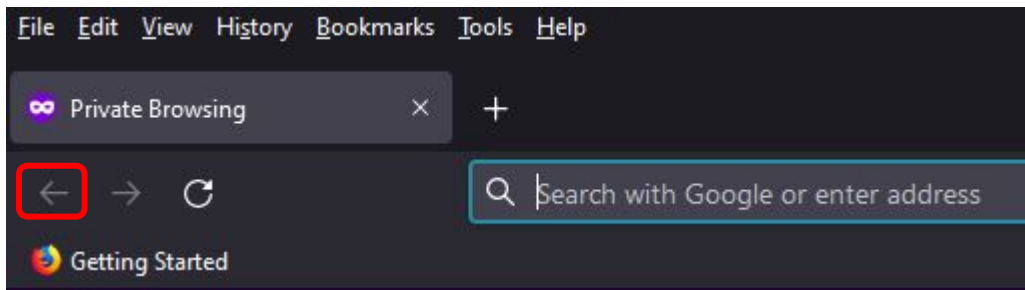
Push
a new book on the top



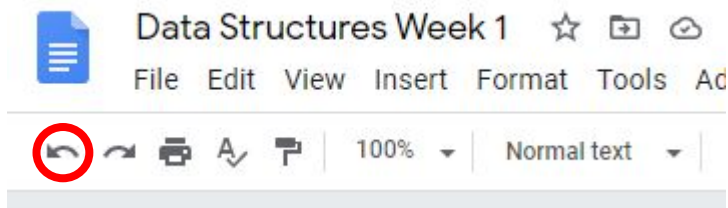
Pop
a book from the top



Stack Applications Example



Web Browser's
history of recently
visited sites.



The undo button.

Stack's Operations



Additional operations of stacks:

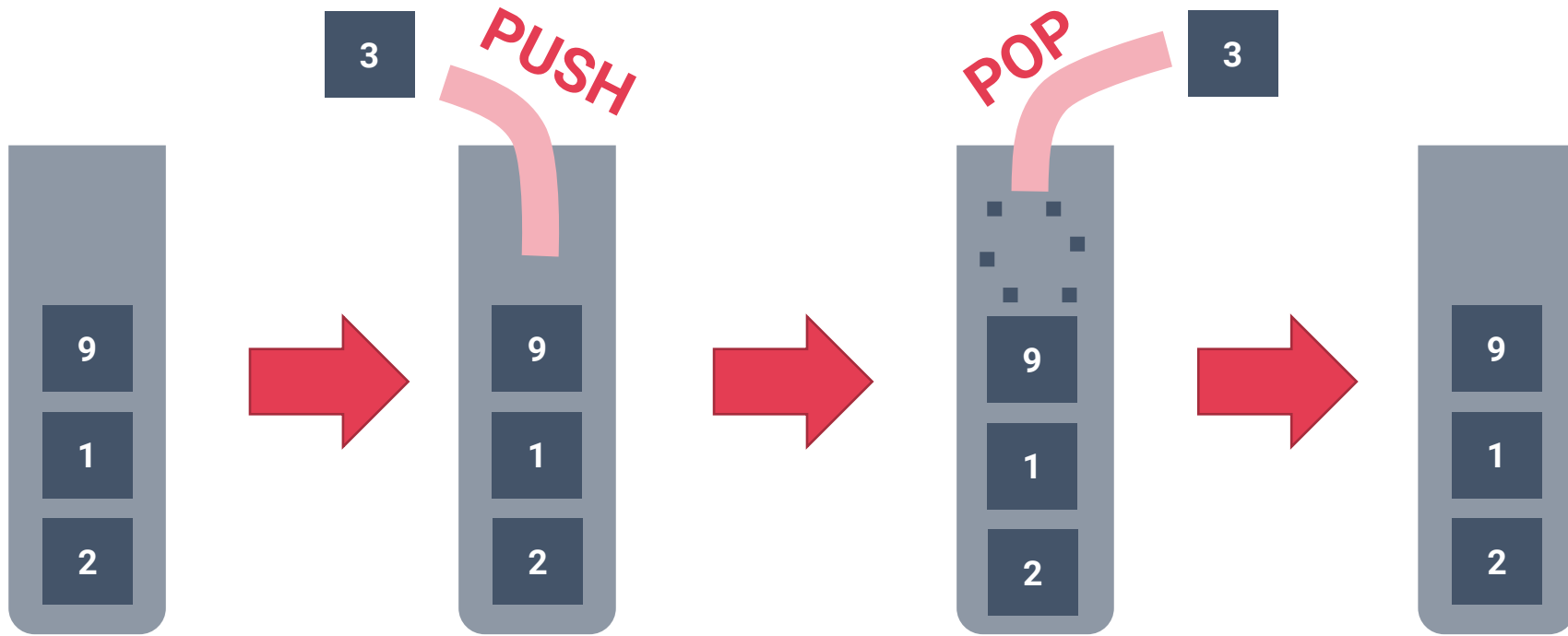
- 1) `top()`
- 2) `is_empty()`
- 3) `len(Stack)`

Stack Implementation



How to Implement a Stack?

Stack Implementation



Stack's Operation Example



Operation	Return Value
S.push(9)	
S.push(5)	
S.top()	
S.push(2)	
S.pop()	
S.is_empty()	
len(S)	

Stack

Asymptotic Performance



Operation	Running Time
S.push(element)	$O(1)$
S.pop()	$O(1)$
S.top()	$O(1)$
S.is_empty()	$O(1)$
len(S)	$O(1)$

Stack Implementation



How to Implement a Stack using a Python?

Stack Implementation

Create ArrayStack class and its methods

```
[2] 1 class ArrayStack:
2     def __init__(self):
3         """ Create an empty stack. """
4         self._data = [] # Initiate a nonpublic list instance
5
6     def __len__(self):
7         """ Return the number of elements in the stack. """
8         return len(self._data)
9
10    def is_empty(self):
11        """ Return True if the stack is empty. """
12        return len(self._data) == 0
13
14    def push(self, element):
15        """ Add an element to the top of the stack. """
16        self._data.append(element) # new item stored at end of list
17
```

Stack Implementation

```
18 def top(self):
19     """ Return (but do not remove) the element at the top of the stack.
20     Raise an exception if the stack is empty. """
21     if self.is_empty():
22         print('Stack is empty')
23         raise Empty('Stack is empty') # Calling subclass Empty
24     return self._data[-1] # the last item in the list
25
26 def pop(self):
27     """ Remove and return the element from the top of the stack.
28     Raise an exception if the stack is empty. """
29     if self.is_empty():
30         print('Stack is empty')
31         raise Exception('Stack is empty') # Alternate way to call subclass Empty
32     return self._data.pop() # remove last item from the list
33
```

```
[3] 1 class Empty(Exception):
    2     """ Error attempting to access an element from an empty container. """
    3     pass
```


Stack Applications



1) Simple Balanced Parentheses

Each opening symbol must match its corresponding closing symbol.

Parentheses:

Examples

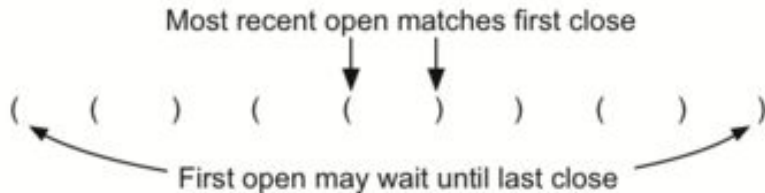
Balanced:

Unbalanced:

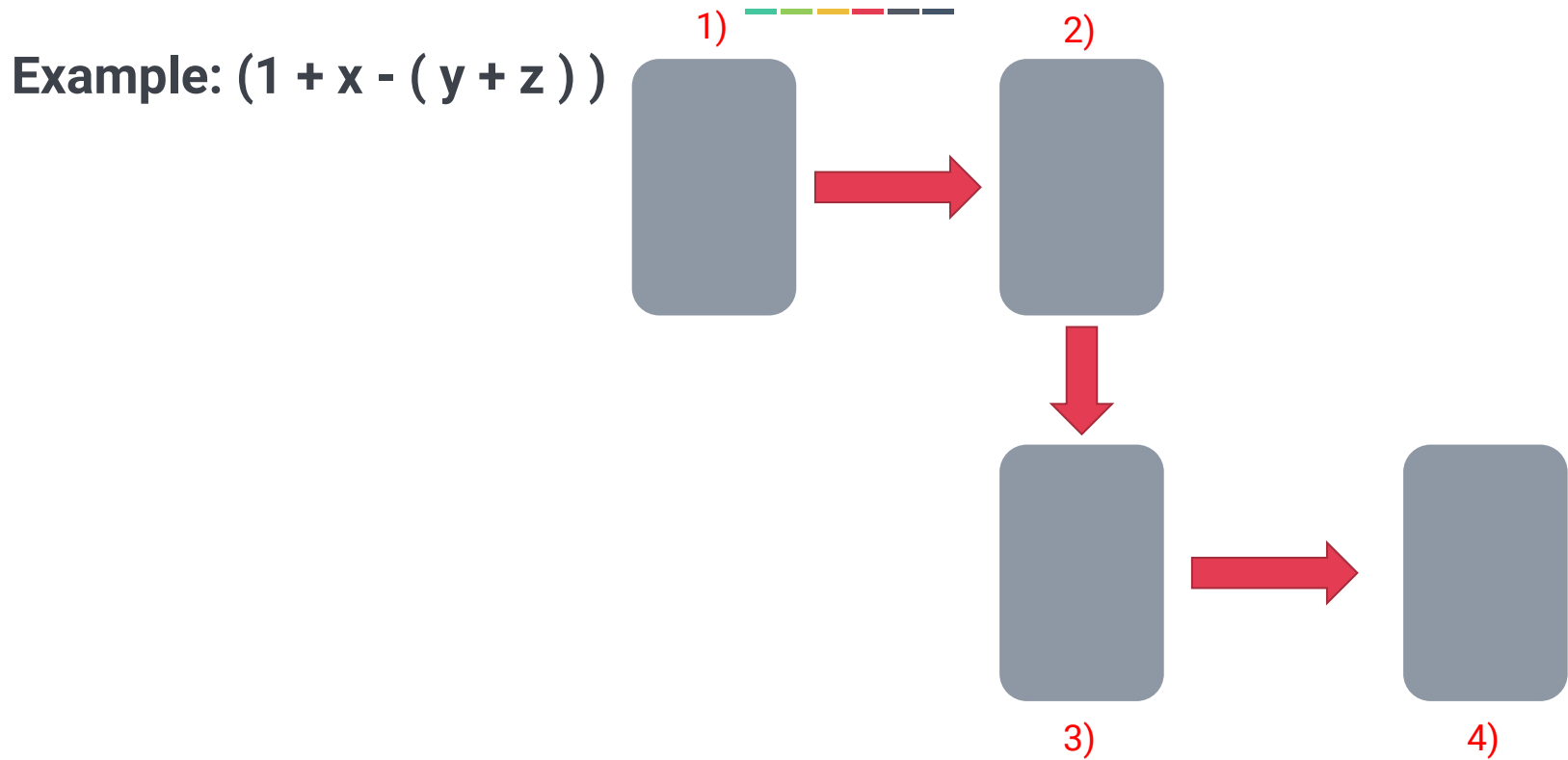
Simple Balanced Parentheses



How to check balanced parentheses?



Simple Balanced Parentheses



Balanced Parentheses Algorithm

IsBalanced(str):



Stack Applications



2) Balanced Grouping Symbols

Each opening symbol must match its corresponding closing symbol.

Parentheses:

Brackets:

Braces:

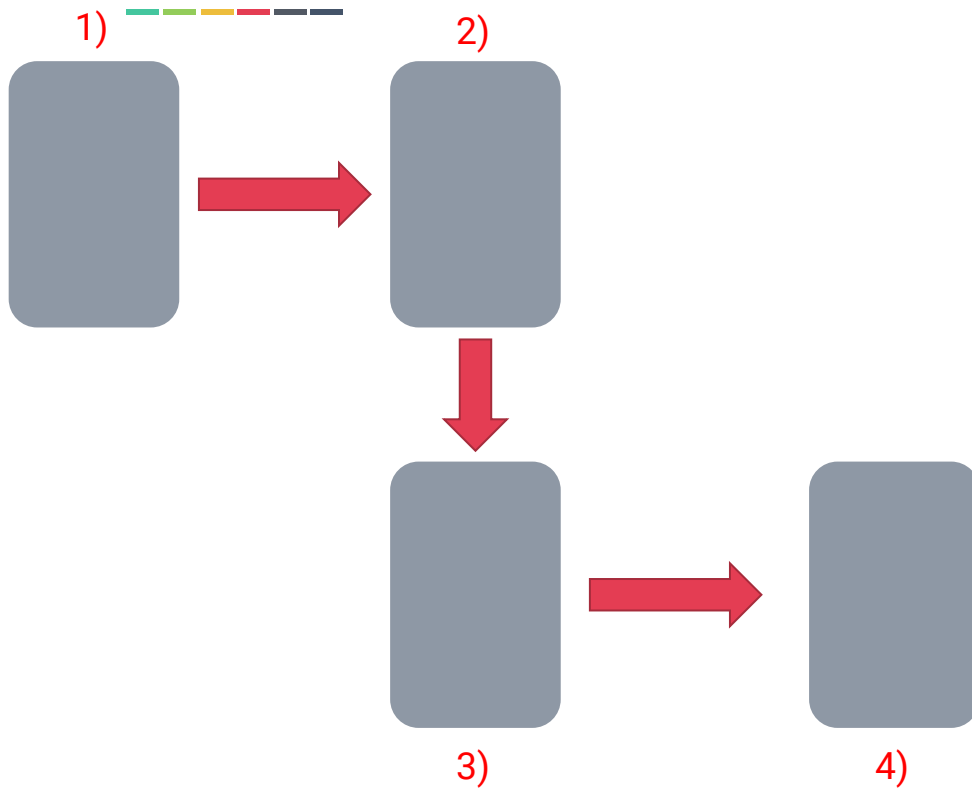
Examples

Balanced:

Unbalanced:

Balanced Grouping Symbols

Example: $(1 + x - [y + z])$



Balanced Symbols Algorithm



IsBalanced(str):

```
s = ArrayStack()
```

```
...
```

```
...
```

```
...
```

```
...
```

```
...
```

```
return s.is_empty()
```